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Manic Monday: Global market selloff worsens

■ DECLINES FOLLOW \$5TR LOSS IN US MARKET CAP ■ TRUMP THREATENS EXTRA 50% TARIFF ON CHINA



Bloomberg

■ Traders take in the gloomy news on the floor of the New York Stock Exchange yesterday.

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN GEORGE VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Waves of volatility rocked global markets once again as stocks were whipsawed by renewed fears of a deepening trade war. The latest selloff intensified after US President Donald Trump threatened to slap an additional 50 per cent tariff on Chinese goods, sparking alarm among investors.

US equities swung between gains and losses, with the volatility reflecting the uncertainty investors face amid a barrage of headlines. A staggering \$9.5 trillion has been wiped off global market values, pushing the US equities nearly 20 per cent below its record high. European stocks opened sharply lower, with Frankfurt plunging as much as 10 per cent before trimming losses. Other major indices dropped over 5 per cent.

In Asia, the mood was equally grim. A key index slumped nearly 8 per cent, its sharpest one-day decline in over 16 years. Hong Kong's Hang Seng Index suffered its worst day since the 2008 financial crisis after Beijing imposed 34 per cent tariffs on all US imports.

UAE STOCKS FEEL FULL TARIFF PRESSURE

UAE stock markets were deep in the red yesterday, tracking global losses tied to escalating US-China trade tensions. The Dubai Financial Market General Index dropped 5.77 per cent at the open, later narrowing losses to 3 per cent. In Abu Dhabi, the ADX General Index slid as much as 3.8 per cent before settling 2.6 per cent lower.

Emaar Properties and Emaar Development both fell over 8 per cent. Dubai Islamic Bank dropped 7.5 per cent. On ADX, Adnoc Gas, First Abu Dhabi Bank (FAB), and Multiply declined between 7.2 per cent and 9.3 per cent. Analysts said UAE markets initially held up better than Asia, but have now joined the broader global downturn. Many new retail investors, who entered during the 2022 IPO surge, are facing their first significant correction.

Unless there is a breakthrough in trade negotiations, analysts expect continued pressure. Banking and insurance stocks remain among the most heavily impacted.

— Manoj Nair, Business Editor

Chinese tech stocks sank as much as 16 per cent. India's Sensex fell 3 per cent, with Taiwan logging its steepest daily drop ever, while.

Rocky week

Traders braced for a rocky week ahead, fearing that an all-out trade war could tip the global economy into recession. "The swift stock market decline is a repricing to reflect an impending recession," said Richard Saperstein of Treasury Partners. "Markets won't rebound until tariffs are re-

duced, valuations become compelling, and fundamentals improve."

Wall Street billionaires Bill Ackman and Stanley Druckenmiller condemned Trump's global tariff push. JPMorgan CEO Jamie Dimon called for swift resolution, while Fed Chair Jerome Powell signalled no immediate response. "The market fallout from tariffs won't ease soon," said Win Thin of Brown Brothers Harriman. "With no policy change in sight, pressure on equities will persist."

SEE ALSO P6

New CBSE dual-exam system to change academic calendar

It will require schools to delay start of class 11 academic year

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The introduction of a dual-exam system for class 10 students starting in the 2025-26 academic year by India's Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) is likely to require CBSE schools in the UAE to change the academic calendar for class 11.

CBSE has decided to allow class 10 students to take the

Board exam twice annually, in February and April. However, this has posed challenges for schools in the UAE, where the academic year runs from April to March.

The dual-exam system is optional, but it will require schools to delay the start of the academic year for class 11 until all grade 10 students, who opt for the second exam, complete their assessments.

Educators in the UAE, who spoke to *Gulf News*, said the policy has elicited mixed reactions about the impact and some plan to give constructive feedback to the Board.

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Hamdan begins India visit today

Dubai Crown Prince's trip aims to strengthen UAE-India relations

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of UAE, will embark on an official visit to India today.

During the visit, Shaikh Hamdan will hold talks with senior Indian officials to explore ways to enhance bilateral cooperation and strengthen partnerships across various strategic sectors.

The visit underscores the UAE leadership's strategy of building strategic alliances with key international partners to foster growth, drive innovation and enhance collaboration across vital sectors.

Shaikh Hamdan will be accompanied by a high-level delegation that includes Shaikh Ahmad Bin Saeed Al Maktoum, President of the Dubai Civil Aviation Authority, Chairman of Dubai Airports, and Chairman and Chief Executive of Emirates Airline and Group; Mohammad Bin Abdullah Al Gergawi, Minister of Cabinet Affairs; Reem Bint Ebrahim Al Hashimy, Minister of State for International Cooperation; Dr Ahmad Belhouli Al Falasi, Minister of Sports; Abdullah Bin Touq Al Marri, Minister of Economy; Mohammad Bin Hadi Al Hussaini, Minister of State for Financial Affairs, and Omar Bin Sultan Al Olama, Minister of State for Artificial Intelligence, Digital Economy, and Remote Work Applications.



COMMENT
India brings scale, UAE delivers speed

When I think of India, I think of family.

Not just because over 3.8 million Indians call the UAE their second home, but because our bonds stretch across many generations and span several centuries.

As I make my first official visit to India at Prime Minister Narendra Modi's gracious invitation, I carry with me stories passed down through four generations of the Al Maktoum family — stories about friendship, trust and shared dreams. India stands apart as one of the rare nations to have welcomed all four generations of my family.

Shaikh Hamdan writes about the historic ties between the two countries as he visits India | P9



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Your skin reflects what you feel inside | P8

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